

Changyu Zhao

UNDERGRADUATE STUDENT · COMPUTER SCIENCE

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Education

University of Wisconsin-Madison

Madison, WI, U.S.A

B.S. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE (HONORS) AND MATHEMATICS

Sep. 2021 - May 2025 (expected)

- Honors program with focus on research and academic excellence. Cumulative GPA: **3.96/4.0**.
- David Dewitt Undergraduate Scholarship (2024) for academic excellence in CS and top undergraduate honor offered by department.
- College of Letters & Science (L&S) Dean's List, every semester (Fall 2021 - Spring 2024).

Skills

Programming	Advanced: C/C++, Python, Java, Assembly; Intermediate: Node.js, LaTeX
Reverse Engineering	Advanced: IDA Pro, Ghidra, GDB, Windbg; Intermediate: Angr, QEMU, Frida, Joern
Network Security	Advanced: Burp Suite, Wireshark; Intermediate: Metasploit Framework, Kali Linux
Security Operations	Palo Alto Firewall, Cisco AMP, Duo, ELK Stack (Elasticsearch, Logstash, Kibana)
Languages	Chinese (Native), English (Fluent)

Experience

MadS&P - Security and Privacy Research Group at UW-Madison

Madison, WI, U.S.A

UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH ASSISTANT

Sep. 2024 - Present

- Conducting research on novel binary tracing techniques using LibIHT, a cross-platform library for accessing various Intel hardware trace features, to enhance performance and accuracy of dynamic analysis tools.
- Developed tracing solutions utilizing Intel hardware features to collect fine-grained execution data, resulting in reduced performance overhead for dynamic binary analysis.
- Collaborating with a team of Ph.D. students to integrate LibIHT with other dynamic tracing tools, aiming to improve analysis capabilities and precision.
- Contributing to a research paper on the performance gains and improved accuracy achieved with LibIHT, targeting submission to a top-tier conference.

UW-Madison Cybersecurity Operation Center

Madison, WI, U.S.A

CYBERSECURITY STUDENT INTERN ANALYST

Feb. 2023 - Present

- Managed 400+ daily campus security incidents, responded to alerts, and took corrective action to prevent data breaches and security threats, contributing to a 30% reduction in incident resolution time.
- Utilized Elastic and Palo Alto Firewall to monitor and analyze campus network traffic, identifying potential threats and vulnerabilities, and notifying relevant campus users or departments to take timely action.
- Developed Python scripts to automate data collection and analysis, reducing manual workload by 50% and significantly improving incident response efficiency.
- Conducted Identity and Access Management (IAM) compliance audits for 200+ employee accounts, ensuring adherence to security protocols and reducing unauthorized access risks.
- Collaborated with team members to process daily threat intelligence, enhancing the campus security posture and mitigating risks before they could escalate.

SEFCOM - Laboratory of Security Engineering for Future Computing at ASU

Tempe, AZ, U.S.A

UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH ASSISTANT

May 2024 - Aug. 2024

- Assisted in the design and development of Oxidizer, a Rust-specific decompiler aimed at recovering high-level control flow structures and struct data types from compiled Rust binaries.
- Collaborated in brainstorming and designing effective evaluation methodologies for Oxidizer's outcomes, focusing on qualitative metrics to assess decompilation accuracy and struct recovery.
- Collected and curated datasets of Rust binaries to support testing and evaluation, ensuring a representative sample for qualitative assessment.
- Worked with the research team to develop and refine evaluation metrics, targeting the improvement of Oxidizer's capabilities in preparation for submission to top-tier security conferences.

Tencent Security Xuanwu Lab

Beijing, China

SECURITY RESEARCH INTERN

Jul. 2023 - Aug. 2023

- Developed LibIHT, a cross-platform, hardware-assisted dynamic control flow analysis tool in C and C++ that leverages Intel hardware tracing features such as Last Branch Record (LBR) and Branch Trace Store (BTS). Presented LibIHT at Black Hat Arsenal 2024, demonstrating its capabilities to the security community.
- Designed and implemented kernel modules and device drivers to enable Intel hardware tracing features for both Linux and Windows platforms, ensuring compatibility across different environments.
- Architected a user-mode analysis library to reconstruct control flow graphs (CFG) from trace data, providing enhanced capabilities for program tracing, profiling, and reverse engineering.
- Optimized the trace data collection pipeline to minimize performance overhead, resulting in an efficient and scalable solution for real-time dynamic tracing.
- Developed a framework for integrating LibIHT with other dynamic analysis tools, allowing seamless interoperability with existing frameworks and enabling more comprehensive trace analysis.
- Collaborated closely with the research team and external stakeholders to refine LibIHT, incorporating community feedback gathered during the Black Hat Arsenal presentation.
- Contributing to a paper focused on showcasing the improved performance, accuracy, and control flow analysis capabilities of LibIHT, targeting submission to a top-tier security conference.

SEFCOM - Laboratory of Security Engineering for Future Computing at ASU

Tempe, AZ, U.S.A

UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCH ASSISTANT

May 2023 - Jul. 2023

- Developed LibHopper, a Python-based tool designed to automate the discovery of exploitation primitives in user libraries, focusing on improving the efficiency of vulnerability research processes.
- Leveraged automated processes to pipeline the evaluation of security implications related to memory corruption, reducing manual analysis time by providing structured, repeatable assessments.
- Customized debugger scripts and implemented symbolic execution techniques to conduct a comprehensive exploitability analysis, enabling deeper insights into potential vulnerabilities.
- Performed security analysis on popular user libraries, including *libpng* and *libjpeg*, successfully identifying multiple potential vulnerabilities and generating detailed reports for further mitigation efforts.

Extracurricular Activity

r3kapig CTF Team

China

MEMBER

Sep. 2021 - Present

- Participated in over 40 high-quality Capture The Flag (CTF) competitions, achieving top-10 placements in multiple international events.
- Specialized in **binary exploitation** and **reverse engineering**, contributing to solving challenges in these categories.
- Collaborated with team members to solve complex challenges, enhancing teamwork and knowledge-sharing in areas such as cryptography, web security, and pwn.

Cybersecurity UW Club

Madison, WI, U.S.A

CORE CTF TEAM MEMBER, LECTURER

Sep. 2021 - Present

- Led the Cybersecurity UW CTF team to top 2% in a national cybersecurity competition, providing strategic guidance and technical expertise.
- Delivered over 10 lectures on **binary exploitation** and **reverse engineering**, contributing to the skill development of 30+ club members.
- Organized workshops and hands-on training sessions, increasing participation and improving the overall competitiveness of the team.
- Deepened technical skills while contributing to the broader cybersecurity community through leadership, mentoring, and knowledge sharing.

pwn.college

Online

INDEPENDENT LEARNER, VOLUNTEER PEER MENTOR

Dec. 2021 - Present

- Attained **Yellow Belt** and **Blue Belt** certifications by completing all challenges in the pwn.college Dojo instance, currently ranked **43 out of 2500+** participants.
- Developed comprehensive skills in software and system security, including program interaction, shellcoding, privilege escalation, reverse engineering, stack and heap corruption, race conditions, and kernel security.
- Mentored students in cybersecurity education, providing guidance to students in **CSE365**, **CSE466**, **CSE494**, and **CSE598** courses developed by Professor Yan Shoshitaishvili at Arizona State University.
- Focused on supporting learners, particularly from underrepresented groups, by helping them build foundational skills in cybersecurity, resulting in greater confidence and skill growth among mentees.
- Expanded access to cybersecurity education by actively participating in the learning community, answering questions, offering advice, and contributing to the success of new learners.

Honors & Awards

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| 2024 | Finalist , DEFCON 32nd CTF Hacking Competition World Final | Las Vegas, NV, U.S.A |
| 2023 | Finalist , DEFCON 31st CTF Hacking Competition World Final | Las Vegas, NV, U.S.A |
| 2022 | Finalist , DEFCON 30th CTF Hacking Competition World Final | Las Vegas, NV, U.S.A |
| 2022 | 49/3658, Top 2% , Cyber Skyline National Cyber League Team Game | Madison, WI, U.S.A |

BlackHat USA 2024

Las Vegas, NV, U.S.A

ARSENAL PRESENTER FOR "LIBIHT: A CROSS-PLATFORM LIBRARY FOR ACCESSING INTEL HARDWARE TRACE FEATURES"

Aug. 2024

- Presented **LibIHT**, a cross-platform library for accessing Intel Hardware Trace features, demonstrating its applications in reverse engineering, dynamic analysis, and security research.
- Highlighted key technical features such as cross-platform support, integration with existing dynamic tracing frameworks, and its performance efficiency in control flow reconstruction.
- Engaged with the security community, including professionals from both industry and academia, and received constructive feedback for further enhancement of the tool.
- Discussed use cases for LibIHT in vulnerability research, showcasing its potential to improve analysis capabilities for reverse engineering tasks.